FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-24006

Issue Title : 737MAX Aeronautical Telecomunications Network (ATN) datalink Provider Abort Logon problems over some Eurocontrol Centers

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-10, -7, -8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
01/19/2026	01/19/2026	06/04/2024
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
03/29/2026	01/30/2026	

Description

Operators have reported Aeronautical Telecommunications Network (ATN) logon issues over some European countries. Additionally, operators have reported their ability to logon to ATN centers but not other Eurocontrol centers unexpectedly when using Thales Ground End System (GES) only.

Status

Boeing's analysis has confirmed that a CONTROLLER PILOT DATA LINK COMMUNICATION (CPDLC) Start Confirmation sent from an aircraft contains an unexpected bit string length in the Protocol Data Unit (PDU). In this event, the length field contained 48 bits from the aircraft's Flight Management Computer (FMC). However, the GES application data only expects 46 bits.

This mismatch causes the GES (Ground End System) to reject the PDU as invalid and respond to the aircraft with a Provider Abort (PA). This "Provider Abort" issue only affects 737aircraft configured with the U14 / FANS-2 option enabled.

Current 737 airplanes in the fleet with ATN-Only CPDLC and not configured with U14 / FANS-2 are not affected with this issue. In the 737 ATN only configuration, the ATN CPDLC application is hosted in the communication management unit (CMU) and therefore not affected. Boeing has made contact with Eurocontrol and have confirmed that the U14/FANS-2 implementation of ATN CPDLC includes two extra unexpected bits in the Boeing FMC implementation which results in the mismatch. Boeing has contacted the FMC supplier General Electric (GE) for a review of the FMC software and have confirmed this issue. Additionally, since this issue only occurs with Thales GES's, Boeing has contacted Eurocontrol to investigate a potential ground-based solution. Some ATN ATC centers can handle more 46 bit implementation without responding with a PA. Unfortunately, the list of ATN Centers who respond with PA is not available at this time.

To confirm this PA issue occurred, an analysis of the event specific datalink audits is necessary.

GE, the supplier for the 737 FMS software, has a fix available for this issue. The fix is planned to be included in U14.2. At this time the U14.2 software project is in the planning stage, currently targeting Certification per the milestone date.

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Interim Action

There is no operator interim action at this time. Boeing has contacted Eurocontrol to notify GES of this issue in attempt to minimize operational impact. Operators are encouraged to review the list of flagged Thales ground centers as shown in the attachment for potential operational issues.

Final Action

Incorporate FMS software update U14.2 via Service bulletin.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: Complete

Solution Selected: Complete

Service Bulletin: FMS OPS U14.2 is scheduled for late 2026 (target)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-34-21005		

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

Attachments:

a) List of Suspect Thales Ground Centers

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